Being & Becoming - Usage Guide

What does this tool help you do and why does that matter?

The Being & Becoming tool is a place where you can:

- Get a better understanding of yourself.
- Reinforce all the wonderful aspects of your authentic self.
- Energise yourself by noticing how you are feeling, what's going well and how things change over time.
- Take action by surfacing small, manageable actions and things to try when confronted with opportunities, challenges and new scenarios.
- Sustain positive new habits through consistent use.

A log for noticing your own state over time — not a tracker that grades you against a target. Every score in this tool is a self-rating, compared only with your own past.

Getting started

Accessing and installing the tool

iPhone

Open whatnowwhatnext.co.uk/being-and-becoming/ in Safari, tap the Share icon, then “Add to Home Screen.” That gives you an icon that opens the tool full-screen, installed like any other app.

Android

Open the same address in Chrome. Chrome will often prompt you to install it automatically; if it doesn't, tap the three-dot menu (top right), then “Add to Home screen” (sometimes worded “Install app”), then confirm. The exact wording occasionally shifts between Chrome versions — if what you see differs slightly from this, look for an option along these lines.

Computer

Open the same address in your browser and bookmark it.

The tool works fully offline, keeping your data locally in your device's browser unless you deliberately export or copy something. Everything is private by design.

As a direct consequence of this approach to privacy, different devices keep their own separate copies of your data and do not sync. If you use multiple devices to view or edit your data, treat backup and restore (next section) as how you move data between them, not just as protection against loss.

Adding content

There are different ways to start adding content to the tool:

- Add some content you already have — maybe from some existing documents (coaching notes, profiling reports…), which you might have sitting in a drawer or a folder somewhere.
- Pick a page where you have some clear thoughts on who you are and want to be — for example, your values, or goals. Add some initial content. Iterate and evolve it over time.
- Create new content by using the surveys and tool links contained within the tool.
- Take time to reflect and build on your understanding of yourself. Notice what's important, or any patterns in your thinking or behaviour.
- Identify and frame a goal, challenge or opportunity where your approach should reflect who you are. Refer to the content in the tool to define an approach that excites you.

Take a look at the “Example” workspace to get an idea of what content can be added.

Look for “+ Add” or “Manage…” buttons to add or edit content (‘Manage values’, ‘Manage goals’, ‘Manage skills’…). This is where you name your actual goals, values, skills, and criteria.

Once pages have content, the ongoing rhythm is to ‘Check in’ — recording how you're feeling about things right now. You can also view your ‘History’ to look back over past entries, where you can also edit or delete any of them individually, anytime. That's the week-to-week (or whenever-feels-right) use of the tool.

Backing up your data

Since your data is stored locally in your device's browser rather than in the cloud, remember to back up regularly. Because of this privacy-by-design approach, there's no automatic copy sitting anywhere else if something goes wrong on your end.

How to back up

1. Click Manage, top right of the header.
2. Under “Backup for [workspace name] only,” click Download backup.
3. Save the file it downloads somewhere you'll remember — a folder on your computer, or emailed to yourself, both work fine.

Do this regularly, and especially before switching devices or clearing browser data.

If restoring a backup doesn't work

On some mobile browsers, the “choose a file” step can be unreliable. If Restore backup doesn't respond properly, use **Paste backup text instead** in the same Manage section: open the backup file elsewhere so you can see its text, copy all of it, and paste it in — you'll get an on-screen confirmation before anything is applied.

Managing multiple workspaces

If you're managing multiple workspaces from one device browser (see “Managing workspaces” below), use ‘Export all workspaces / Restore all workspaces’ instead — also in Manage — to move all workspaces' data across in one step rather than one at a time.

The pages

1. Home

A visual way in — photo tiles linking to every page you are using and want to see. In ‘Manage’, you can edit which tiles you see, in case you want to focus on a smaller set of pages. A link at the bottom of the page opens Instructions for the fuller version of how to use this tool. Instructions also lists the open-source software the tool is built with, and the licences each component is used under.

2. Snapshot

A live view of what matters most right now, built around one guiding question: “What’s your current focus?”

At the top, a ★ Current focus box holds whatever you’ve starred. Tap the ☆ next to any value, goal, quality, skill, energiser, drainer, action, habit, learning or bright spot on this page to pull it into that box (it turns into a ★); tap again to remove it. Star or unstar anything, anytime — every change is kept in a Focus history log, opened via the link in the box, so you can look back at how your focus has shifted over time.

Directly below that sits Today’s question — a small daily habit-building prompt. It picks one of your currently-starred items and one of six standard coaching questions (Why is this important? What’s the biggest barrier you face to making progress? What options do you have to make progress? How might you make taking action easier? Who could you connect with to help you? And, for habits and learnings, a looking-back question: What difference has this made?), pre-filled with a sensible default each time but fully changeable via two dropdowns. Save an answer and it’s kept in a dated log — view the whole thing via Context history — or use Turn into an action to create a new Action straight from what you’ve just written, linked to the same goal if the starred item is one. The same questions are also available directly on an item’s own edit screen, under Reflection questions, if you’d rather answer one there instead.

Below that, the page brings together: Values at a glance; Goals at a glance, with anything “Worth revisiting” shown underneath; Habits at a glance (your active habits, with how you’re feeling about each); Qualities & Styles at a glance (your ‘Very important’ traits, plus any Energisers or Drainers you’ve also flagged ‘Very important’); your Will, Skill & Connectivity levels, plus any skills flagged ‘Very important’; your most recent Learning; your three most recent Bright Spots; and an Actions box — normally your three most recently added actions, switching automatically to whatever’s overdue or due within the next 14 days once any open action carries a deadline.

As well as the on-screen snapshot, you can choose to export a specific snapshot:

Snapshot for Claude

This turns your data into a text snapshot you can paste into a new Claude conversation, ahead of asking a real question — “how should I approach this forthcoming meeting,” for example. This enables Claude to give you an answer that is truly tailored to you. The Snapshot explicitly asks Claude to check it for anything relevant to your question. If you’ve filled in ‘How I like to learn and connect’ (see Qualities & Styles), those preferences are included too, so suggestions can fit how you like to learn.

Snapshot for your accountability partner

To help you be yourself and become your best self, you may choose to work with someone who can help motivate you and make progress. We call these people ‘accountability partners’. This function provides a readable, curated snapshot built specifically for sharing with them — to paste into a text, email, or WhatsApp message. It covers Goals, Habits, Actions, Learnings, and Bright Spots — the information typically required to run a useful accountability session, without unnecessarily sharing any additional data. Each habit can be left out individually, in its own edit screen.

Two versions are offered: a snapshot of what's currently going on, or of everything since you last shared. Both versions can also include a “U0001F4C8 Trends noticed” section, listing only whichever Values or Will/Skill/Connectivity dimensions you've chosen.

Snapshot for your own analysis

This tile provides all your data in a spreadsheet, one sheet per section — including your Habits and Focus history — for analysing more deeply than the tool's own charts allow (custom pivots, correlations across sections, that sort of thing).

🎉 Last 12 months snapshot

This snapshot provides a gentle look back — actions completed, learnings added, bright spots noticed, targets reached, and any notable rises. Generated each time from the last 12 months of activity, with a Copy button to paste it wherever you like.

3. Values

A record of the values to which you want to stay true, with the ability to check in on how far you feel you're living by them. To help you identify the values that resonate, a curated list of 80 suggested values, organised by direction and category, is available, or you can type your own. ‘History’ lets you review, edit, or delete any past entry.

Once you've added a few values, a “Read the full guide to Values” link appears at the bottom of the page with reminders on how you can add content and use the page on an ongoing basis.

Please note each value can optionally have its trend (rising/steady/dipped — never the score) included in the accountability-partner snapshot. This is turned off by default, but can be turned on per the value you set in Edit Value. The same screen also lets you give it an Importance ranking (No ranking/Somewhat important/Important/Very important — the same scale used throughout the tool) and answer the same reflection questions as Snapshot’s “Today’s question” directly from there.

🌟 Bright Spots

A place to notice and keep real evidence of you living your values. To note, reinforce and celebrate what's going on. Add one from any value, providing a short description, the date, the value it relates to, optionally a linked goal, and optionally an Importance ranking. Its own edit screen also offers the “Why is this important?” reflection question — the same prompt used in Snapshot’s “Today’s question.”

4. Goals

A record of your ‘big picture’ goals across one or more life domains (primary relationships, friends & family, career & work, recreation & fun, finances, faith & spirituality, health & wellness), with the ability to track how you're feeling about them and your progress towards them.

There are two levels — goals and sub-goals — each independently checkable with full check-in History. If a goal has sub-goals, it defaults to their average, but a direct check-in always overrides that.

If you wish, you can also add the goal targets you're working towards. But the priority is simply to notice how you are feeling about your goals — not to feel pressured about targets and deadlines.

Once you've added a goal or two, a “Read the full guide to Goals” link appears at the bottom of the page with reminders on how you can add content and use the page on an ongoing basis.

Please note a goal can optionally be linked to one or more Values in Edit Goal (tap any that fit), each shown as a tag on the goal and counted on that value's own card. The same screen also lets you give the goal an Importance ranking — distinct from Target, which is a score rather than a ranking — and answer the same reflection questions as Snapshot’s “Today’s question.” Any bright spots or habits linked to a goal also show as a small count next to it. Each goal can be individually excluded from the accountability-partner snapshot, in Manage Goals — useful for a goal you'd rather keep private even from a partner.

Check-in rhythm

Each goal can be given a check-in rhythm — providing guidance on how frequently you'd like to check in to see how you're feeling about this goal. A goal can have its own check-in rhythm (e.g. weekly/monthly/quarterly), or you can set one check-in rhythm for all your goals (set once in Manage Goals, or the first time you align a goal to it). A quiet “Worth a check-in?” note appears on the goal once it's elapsed, and on the Snapshot page under “Goals worth revisiting.”

Goal Relevance

A link at the bottom of the page opens Goal Relevance. This section helps you weigh up different approaches you are considering, to help you make progress towards a specific goal.

Choose a goal and decide what set of criteria might govern a productive approach to making progress. Score one or more potential approaches based on these criteria.

5. Habits

A place to build habits that support who you want to be — small, repeatable things, chosen in service of your values and goals. As everywhere else in the tool, it is about how you feel, not a scorecard: there are no targets, streaks, tallies or ‘missed’ markers.

To add a habit, you are walked through six numbered sections, one screen at a time; only the description is needed to save, and ‘Save now, finish later’ keeps what you have so far. If you prefer, switch to the full form, which shows all six sections on one page (editing an existing habit always uses the full form). The sections are: (1) Get started — describe the habit in your own words, when and where it happens, and the outcome, as one or more benefits; (2) Plan the activity — the steps that make up the habit, a SMART goal and target in your own words, and how you will build the habit up in phases; (3) Make it simple — the activity trigger (the event that will prompt it), the smallest, easiest step to start with, and a piggyback activity (something you already do that can come first); (4) Make it stick — the reward that makes it immediately worth doing, someone who can support you, and the signs that it’s working; (5) Check in — its current status and a date to check in on progress and evolve it; and (6) Connect the dots — an Importance ranking, linked Values and Goals, and which of Will, Skill and Connectivity it supports. Each habit can be included in or left out of the accountability-partner snapshot. Each card shows the same six sections: the first four open, with Check in and Connect the dots a tap away. Linked habits are counted on the Value’s and Goal’s own cards. An Action, Learning or Energiser can be turned into a habit with ‘Make a habit’, leaving the original untouched.

Checking in and evolving a habit

Each habit starts as an experiment: you try it, notice what happens, then keep it, adjust it, pause it or let it go. To check in, record how you’re feeling about the habit (0–10), with an optional note; the trend chart shows your own history. After each check-in you’re offered one small thing to adjust — for example, “Can you break this down into an even smaller step?” — drawn from the same fields you used to build the habit: the smaller steps, the trigger, the piggyback activity, the steps, the reward, the phase, when and where, the target, the outcome or the signs it’s working. You can accept it, pick a different one, or skip. Evolve is also available at any time, and ‘How it’s evolved’ lists each change you’ve made, before and after.

Looking back

Each habit has a date to check in on progress and evolve it (field 14), about six weeks after you start unless you choose another, as a moment to look back rather than a deadline. Look back asks “What difference has this made?” and lets you update where the habit stands and set the next date. The same question, and the other reflection questions from Snapshot’s “Today’s question,” are available on the habit’s own edit screen.

6. Qualities & Styles

A reference point for your strengths, qualities and styles. Capture information from tools and exercises that help you understand yourself better. Consider what tools and profiling reports you might have used in the past, dig them out and add salient details to the ‘Behavioural Assessment’. Alternatively, use the links within the tool to third-party public assessments we often use as part of our coaching sessions.

Every item can be given an Importance ranking — No ranking, Somewhat important, Important, or Very important — the same scale used consistently across the whole tool; tap the tag to cycle through it. And, where relevant, a few categories carry their own extra field (a priority order, a score, a %, or the two Meaning-in-Life sub-scores). Each item’s own edit screen also offers the same reflection questions as Snapshot’s “Today’s question,” if you’d rather answer one there.

Alongside your Personality profile sits an ⚡🔋 Energisers & Drainers block, built around the question “What activities and actions give you energy or drain you of it?” Add as many as you like to either list, each with a brief description, an optional related value or two, optional notes, and an optional Importance ranking (the same scale used throughout the tool); reorder either list with the ▲/▼ arrows. Its own edit screen offers the same reflection questions as Snapshot’s “Today’s question” too. If a Learning turns out to describe something that energises or drains you, use ‘Convert to…’ on that Learning to turn it straight into an Energiser or Drainer without retyping it — the original Learning is left exactly as it was.

At the bottom of the page, ‘How I like to learn and connect’ answers the question “How can I best learn what I want to learn — and who could I connect with along the way?” It is a short set of plain-language preferences, not a personality test. Build a ranked list of the ways of learning that work best for you, most useful first — choose from books, podcasts, talks and videos, courses, workshops, events, hands-on projects, teaching or writing it up, coaching or mentoring, learning groups and more, or add your own — and reorder it with the

▲/▼ arrows. Then, if you wish, say how you like to connect: whether you do your best thinking alone, with someone else, with a group, or it depends; one-to-one or in a group; challenge or encouragement; structure or flexibility; and who you most want to learn from or alongside. On their own these are just preferences; their value comes from being read alongside the rest of your workspace — your Values, Goals and Habits, the skills and qualities you most want to develop, what energises you and what you've learned. To put them to work, copy a Snapshot for Claude and ask, for example, "Based on this, what would make my best learning journey?" Claude can suggest the kinds of learning and connection that fit you and, if web search is on in your Claude account, find current examples such as particular books, podcasts, talks, events or people to follow. Everything is optional and private to you: the preferences are included in a Snapshot for Claude, and never in your accountability-partner snapshot.

7. Will, Skill & Connectivity

This section focuses on three important dimensions that affect our mood, happiness and performance.

- Will: the energy and commitment a person brings to their lives.
- Skill: the capability to perform effectively.
- Connectivity: the capacity to create value through relationship, trust and shared purpose.

In 'Manage skills', there is a list of skills for you to browse. It's not exhaustive, but it contains a lot of the 'soft' skills common across many professions — as well as some of the core skills that are less likely to be replaced by AI. You can add skills, give each an Importance ranking (tap the tag to cycle through it, or set it from Edit Skill — the same scale used throughout the tool), optionally link it to one or more Values there too, check in on how happy you are with each, and see a combined trend if you've checked in more than once. Edit Skill also offers the same reflection questions as Snapshot's "Today's question."

Below that, each of the Skill, Will, and Connectivity sections has its own overall score, check-in, and trend chart, always visible. The detail underneath each dimension (mini trend charts and definitions) is tucked into a "Show sub-dimension detail" toggle, collapsed by default.

Each of the three sections has its own "Include this trend" checkbox for the accountability-partner snapshot. If turned on, it provides direction only (rising/steady/dipped), never the actual score.

8. Scratchpad

Somewhere to jot down valuable thoughts to revisit later — not only so a thought isn't lost, but so you can later reflect on it, understand why it might matter, decide what to do about it and where it might live.

This feature was added as a result of our very first phase of user feedback — answering a need someone had to have somewhere to quickly jot down a valuable thought, or something useful they'd heard, without immediately knowing quite where it would fit.

Triaging an entry

Each new Scratchpad entry can be triaged at a later date, when you have time to reflect, work out why it might be important and where it might fit. At that point, you can give it a category, timing, and priority, with room for its benefits, your rationale, and any other notes. You can then turn it into a Goal, Sub-goal, Action, or Learning, or simply flag it to reflect where you've decided it fits (for example, as a Challenge, Opportunity, Strength, Weakness or Deprioritised).

Jot something down anytime, at your own pace. Triage entries as you get to them, not on a schedule.

9. Actions

During your use of the tool, you may uncover new actions you want to take. This provides a place to record them — the small steps you've committed to yourself to take to shape your future. An action doesn't have to carry a deadline, but you can add one if you wish. It can also be given a Context tag (which area of the tool it relates to), a link to a Related goal, one or more linked Values, and an Importance ranking. When you complete an action, you can also capture a Learning from it, or turn the action into a habit with 'Make a habit' (the action itself stays as it is). Its own edit screen offers the same reflection questions as Snapshot's "Today's question" too.

10. Learnings

A place to capture and refer to helpful learnings — with the emphasis on ‘big picture’ learnings that guide the way you can be yourself and become your best self. You can connect one to a current goal or note when it might be relevant to a future opportunity, challenge, or new scenario. Learnings can be added directly or captured when you complete an Action, with a category, an Importance ranking, and optional links to a goal and to one or more Values. You can sort your learnings by date, category, importance, goal, or theme. Its own edit screen also offers the “Why is this important?” and “What difference has this made?” reflection questions — the same prompts used in Snapshot’s “Today’s question.” A learning can also be turned into a habit with ‘Make a habit’.

Learnings themes

As your learnings list grows, Themes can help give the list more structure, usefulness and searchability. You can assign one or more identity-level themes to a learning (e.g. “trusting my own judgement”). This is managed from ‘Manage themes’ (rename, describe, delete, and see how many learnings sit under each). A nudge appears once enough new learnings have piled up since you last organised themes.

If you're not sure what Themes you should use to group learnings, “Organise themes with Claude” can do the heavy lifting. This feature exports your learnings plus your values and goals as identity context, so you can ask Claude to analyse and suggest themes. It defines a fixed reply format for Claude, ready to paste back into the tool — Claude's suggested groupings only update which themes are assigned to each learning; the learnings themselves, and their descriptions, are never changed. You can preview exactly what would change before anything is saved.

Managing workspaces

To manage your workspace, there is a ‘Manage’ button in the top-right corner of the header, alongside a drop-down which enables you to choose the workspace you want to work in (if you have set up multiple). The dropdown switches between workspaces. Whichever one is selected is what you're currently viewing and editing.

Manage is the single home for everything administrative:

- Add a new workspace (e.g. one per client).
- Rename, Duplicate or Delete an existing one.
- Add your name (shown on the Snapshot page).
- Clear all data for the current workspace.
- Customize which pages are shown in the navigation and on the Homepage.[1]
- Backup and restore, for one workspace or all of them.

Each workspace is completely separate — its own goals, values, traits, check-ins, everything.

If the tool is open in more than one browser tab or window at once (easy to do by accident), you'll see a brief on-screen warning — having it open twice can occasionally cause a recent change to go missing. If you see that warning, close one of the tabs.

Giving feedback

A Give Feedback button — in the header, next to Manage, and as a small button in the corner of every screen — lets you flag anything that’s not working, feels confusing, or could be better, or share something you like about it. It opens a short form: which part of the tool it’s about (defaults to wherever you currently are, but you can change it), what kind of note it is (something you like, a bug, a UX issue, a technical issue, or an improvement idea — the wording of the form changes to match), what you’re noticing, what you’d want instead (optional), and how important it feels — plus your name, so it’s clear who it’s from.

Everything you log stays in Manage Feedback (opened via the same button), whether or not you’ve sent it yet. When you’re ready, Prepare email in Manage Feedback gathers everything not yet sent into a ready-to-paste summary, copies it to your clipboard, and opens your email app addressed to hello@whatnowwhatnext.co.uk with the subject already filled in — paste the summary into the body and send. It only ever includes what’s new since you last did this.

Using the tool on an ongoing basis

A number of the pages contain links to instructions on how to use them on an ongoing basis. In general:

- Check in to record how you are feeling.
- Reflect on what your data is telling you; notice any trends or patterns.
- Think about any actions you want to take, or habits you'd like to groove.
- Add any Bright Spots or Learnings that you want to capture.
- Think about how you can apply your understanding of yourself to any current situations, challenges or opportunities.

Check-ins, not evaluations

Every score in this tool (0–10) is a self-rating you set for yourself. Trend charts show your own history — not a comparison to a target.

Goals are the one exception, and only if you choose it: you can set an optional target on a goal or sub-goal (Manage Goals → Edit). It's off by default. When set, it shows as a quiet line of text (“Aiming for 8”) and a soft dashed reference line on the chart.

[1]Please note that if you hide a page, data is hidden and not deleted.

Every check-in, note, and learning has a History view. Review past entries, and edit or delete any of them individually, anytime — useful for correcting a mistake, or simply clearing out what you no longer want kept.

A few habits worth building

- Check in when it's useful, not on a schedule.
- “Working on it” or “Struggling” are just as valid entries as “flowing.” The point is about noticing, not performing well.
- Use the “create an action from this” checkbox wherever you leave a note, if something in it feels worth acting on.
- Hide what you don't need. If a workspace only calls for a handful of pages, trim the rest from Manage rather than working around clutter.
- Create a backup when a session has generated new content — and always before clearing browser data or moving to a new device.

Keeping your data secure

This tool holds a genuinely complete picture of you — values, goals, qualities, check-ins, learnings, themes, bright spots. That's the whole point, but it also means it's worth being deliberate about where that picture is stored and where it goes. There are two different situations to think about, and they call for different approaches.

Part 1 — your data in your browser

How we've set things up: Everything you enter is stored in the browser you use to view the tool, on your own device. Data stays there unless you decide to deliberately export or copy it. You can delete your Being & Becoming data by clearing your browser cookies and other site data. The tool doesn't load anything from other websites while you're using it — the code and fonts it relies on are built into the tool itself.

What's down to you: Local storage in your browser means you rely on the protection you already have set up on your device — for example, a passcode or biometric lock, full-disk encryption, and not sharing your browser profile with anyone else. The same goes for backup and export files you might create. Where you choose to store them (e.g. OneDrive, email, a shared drive) determines how protected they are. Treat a downloaded backup file the same way you'd treat a folder of client notes: know where it lives, and don't leave it somewhere more exposed than it needs to be.

Part 2 — sharing your data with Claude, or with a person

The Snapshot page is where your data can genuinely leave your control — worth pausing on deliberately rather than doing on autopilot. The considerations differ slightly depending which of the on-demand snapshots you're using.

How we've set things up: Each snapshot only ever produces text you then choose to copy and paste somewhere yourself. The accountability-partner snapshot goes further, deliberately excluding your Values scores, Qualities & Styles, Will/Skill/Connectivity, Scratchpad, and Goal Relevance by design. Once you've pasted a snapshot into Claude specifically, whether Claude retains or trains on that conversation depends on a setting you control in your own Claude account, not within the Being and Becoming tool.

What's down to you:

- **Check your Claude privacy setting.** In Settings → Privacy, “Help Improve Claude” controls whether conversations can be used to train future models. If you set the controls to ‘Off', Claude will not use the data for training and will delete the entire conversation after 30-days[2]. If you set the controls to ‘On', the data will be used for training and stored for five years.
- **Review and anonymise data before you paste into Claude or send to a person.** You may consider using initials rather than names, checking for employer, location, or other identifying detail creeping into a Value, Goal, or Learning.
- **Delete a conversation.** Once you've got what you need from a conversation using a Claude snapshot, you can delete the whole conversation.
- **Use a separate account for chats using Being & Becoming snapshots.** You may consider setting up a second Claude account, kept on the training-off setting, used only for this purpose — so it never touches your everyday account's settings or history.
- **Review and edit the saved facts about you in Claude's Memory.** In Settings > Capabilities > Memory, you can review and edit any personal information Claude has retained on you from all your conversations.
- **Move to a business-tier plan if this practice becomes routine.** Claude for Work/Enterprise runs under Commercial Terms rather than Consumer Terms — no training on your data regardless of settings, and a proper data processing agreement. Worth considering if pasting snapshots into Claude becomes a regular part of your practice rather than an occasional one.
- **Agree how a human accountability partner should handle what you send them.** The accountability-partner snapshot is scoped for privacy on your end, but once it's in a text or email, how it's stored is down to them — worth a quick, explicit conversation if the relationship is new.

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[2]There are exceptions to this rule — when automated safety scans flag a conversation, or when the content is classified as legally-required to be kept for longer.